



# david quang pham



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David Quang Pham is an award-winning composer-playwright, science communicator, and aspiring animation screenwriter based in Washington Heights, Manhattan. He is known for authoring and producing musicals that effectively blend science and storytelling, a unique blend that stems from his background as a Vietnamese American scientist and his fascination with Eastern fables and modern science. [🔗](#)



## Education and Background

David holds a Bachelor of Science in Astrophysics and a minor in Theatre from Michigan State University. He furthered his playwriting studies as a Working Title Playwrights apprentice in Atlanta and a Playwrights Foundation fellow in San Francisco. He was born in Wyoming, Michigan, and his experience as a Midwestern child of Vietnamese immigrants influences his attraction to stories exploring the breadth of human potential driven by curiosity. [🔗](#)

## Notable Works and Awards

David's musicals often personify scientific concepts, including:

- **Ellipses:** A universal musical about the Galaxy family and their dog Gravity facing the Big Bang. It has been a semifinalist for the Syracuse NWNV (2024), performed at the Theatre About Science International Conference (2023), and developed by the Musical Theatre Factory (2023), the Milky Way Theatre Company (2023), and the Colorado New Musical Festival (2022).
- **Turnover: A New Leaf:** A plant-based musical exploring themes of immigration, queerness, and environmental awareness, following a mother-son duo of cilantro navigating a new life. It received a nomination for Best Musical and won Best Book and Director (Aliyah Curry) at the 2024 Philadelphia New Musicals Festival. Queer Theatre Kalamazoo is producing the musical at Jolliffe Theatre in May 2025. Turnover has also been performed at The Tank's Pridefest (2024).

 10 sites

**David Quang Pham - Sundance Collab**  
David Quang Pham is an award-winning composer-playwright and...  
 [sundance.org](https://sundance.org) ⋮

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**David Quang Pham \* MUSE**  
Biography. David Quang Pham is a musical theater science...  
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In addition to playwriting and composition, David:

- Plays trombone in the Queer Big Apple Corps, Marching Band Casting, and MUSE's Sitprobe Experience.
- Studies and performs with the Vietnamese zither (đàn tranh), recently for Mekong NYC's 2025 Lunar New Year event.
- Was the 2022 Harriet Tubman Effect Institute commissioned composer.
- Writes for the We Forgot the Title sketch group and is a founding member of CreateTheater and the International Dramaturgy Lab.
- Is a member of the Dramatists Guild, ΣΠΣ (Sigma Pi Sigma - the physics honor society), and ASCAP (American Society of Composers, Authors and Publishers).
- Consults on stories exploring STEM and interviews musical writers for The Public and TheaterMania. [↗](#)

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## What are the main themes explored in 'Turnover: A New Leaf'?

Turnover: A New Leaf is a musical comedy by David Quang Pham, that uses a plant-based setting to explore several main themes. [↗](#)

The core themes include:

- **Prejudice and acceptance:** The musical revolves around two neighboring families, represented by different plant species, who are initially rooted in prejudice against each other due to differing views, particularly regarding queer identity. The narrative explores how the relationships between their children, specifically Parsley and Pyrus, challenge and ultimately help to overcome these prejudices.
- **Immigrant assimilation:** The musical touches on the challenges faced by immigrants, as exemplified by Rau Ram's efforts to earn a "Green Card" within the context of the plant-based society.
- **Coming-of-age:** The story focuses on the journey of the younger generation, Parsley and Pyrus, as they explore their identities, navigate relationships, and challenge the established norms of their families and society.
- **Duality of nature vs. nurture:** The musical delves into the question of how both innate characteristics ("nature") and environmental factors and upbringing ("nurture") shape individuals and their perspectives, particularly concerning identity and acceptance.
- **Family dynamics:** The play explores the complexities of familial relationships, including parental expectations, generational differences, and the impact of parental views on their children's beliefs and choices. [↗](#)

 7 sites

### Turnover: A New Leaf

Jun 28, 2024 — #wegotdirtyou.  
Turnover: A New Leaf is A plant-bas...

 [www.turnovermusical.com](http://www.turnovermusical.com) ⋮

### Learn English Idioms: Turn Over a New Leaf - University Blogs -

Jan 29, 2021 — Learn English Idioms:  
Turn Over a New Leaf \* to alter your...

 Missouri State University ⋮

### Why Trying to 'Turn Over a New Leaf' Keeps Us Stuck - Forge

Sep 11, 2021 — But we don't have to  
stay stuck, provided we're willing to...

 Medium ⋮

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↪ Give an example of how 'nature vs. nurture' is shown through Parsley and Pyrus

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↪ I'd like to know more about the plant-based setting

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↪ Tell me more about David Quang Pham's other works